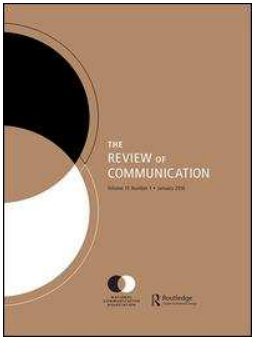

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FORUM

A Centennial Celebration: Benchmarks for Philosophy of Communication

Igor E. Klyukanov & Annette M. Holba

Philosophy of Communicology: "Discourse Which Expresses Itself Is Communication [Heidegger]"

Richard L. Lanigan

In 2013, leadership in the National Communication Association (NCA) released a call for Centennial Panel submissions designed to explore specific aspects of the communication discipline in depth cover the last 100 years. The intention of this call was to focus on various pasts within the discipline in order to demonstrate how these pasts continue to shape, guide, and impact our present scholarship, teaching, and various other engagements. The call explicitly stated that the Centennial Series would provide a textured landscape responsive to the varying ways that its historical terrain could be divided up instead of trying to fit everything into one common theme. In this way, the centennial celebration would be representative of the diverse and complex voices that have come to shape the communication discipline over the last 100 years. The NCA membership was called to take a look at itself from a divisional, interest group, caucus lens and reflect upon its own growth, contribution, and impact that it has had on the larger discipline of communication. The task of this essay is to document the Philosophy of Communication Division's centennial panel that gathered to reflect upon the evolution of philosophy of communication as a field of study within the communication discipline.

The Philosophy of Communication Division (hereafter referred to as "the Division") of the NCA recently evolved from the Semiotic Division. The Division was formed in 1992, which, at that time in the history of the NCA (then named the Speech Communication Association, SCA), was referred to as commission. The initial name was the Semiotics and Communication Commission until the NCA later changed *commission* to *division*. Many communication scholars recognize and understand the conception of semiotics and its value to studying communication in a broader sense, though the Semiotics and Communication Division was not fully

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considered mainstream in the discipline. Semiotics was limited to a narrow understanding as a method for analyzing texts. Submissions to the division declined and membership interest waned resulting in the 2009 divisional name change to the Philosophy of Communication Division which encompasses the range of approaches and interests by its membership. In 2013 we, as division chair, Igor E. Klyukanov, and vice chair, Annette M. Holba, developed a website (http://sites.ewu.edu/philcom/) to provide ongoing information, engagement, and resources for membership and where the centennial panel reflected in this essay can be viewed.

When the centennial call was first initiated for the centennial celebration of the NCA, we decided to submit a centennial panel in the spirit of our dynamic division's history and bring together key scholars in philosophy of communication. We also decided to invite other key philosopher scholars to chair and facilitate the centennial panel discussion. We selected four scholars who have made the most significant contributions to philosophy of communication as a field of thought: Calvin O. Schrag, Purdue University, George Ade Distinguished Professor of Philosophy Emeritus; Ronald C. Arnett, Chair and Professor, Communication & Rhetorical Studies, Duquesne University; Ramsey Eric Ramsey, Associate Dean, Barrett, The Honors College, Arizona State University, West; and Richard L. Lanigan, International Communicology Institute, Director, University Distinguished Scholar and Professor of Communicology Emeritus, Southern Illinois University.

The panel title, *Being (T)here*, reflected philosophical, phenomenological, semiological, and ontological lenses tied to the NCA Centennial convention theme, *The Presence of Our Past(s): NCA at 100*. Our panel description acknowledged that people tend to think of the past as something gone by in time and no longer existing, but we believe not only can the past be as unpredictable as the future, but our past is very much alive —present in our memories and in our very bodies. Likewise, people tend to think of presence as something static—a state or fact of existence, but presence has a dynamic nature as one's bearing (in) the world. As such, presence is a hermeneutic, semiotic and phenomenological process of intersubjectivity and intercorporeality. In this process, we bear witness, and respond, to various events, phenomena, and individuals. Presence is a primordial phenomenon that is the basis of all philosophical inquiry, including its ontological, epistemological and axiological aspects.

In the spirit of the convention centennial theme, the panel was charged to explore the presence of philosophy of communication past(s). Participants on this panel are standard bearers of philosophical inquiry into the nature of communication. These senior scholars have shaped philosophy of communication in diverse ways, and each of their perspectives offers insight into the shaping of our field and our place in the NCA. This panel provided an opportunity to engage with the voices who have shaped what we have come to know as our intellectual dwelling space and who exemplify the essence of philosophical communication inquiry—being (t)here.

Each participant reflected on being (t)here by considering how certain landmark events, phenomena, and individuals influenced philosophy of communication and how, in its turn, philosophy of communication marked its influence on the world in which we live today. Panelists were asked to consider various "pasts" in philosophy

of communication from their individual perspectives and ruminate on how those pasts have influenced the presence of philosophy of communication within the discipline of communication, while offering insights into human meaning, understanding, and engagement. There were remembrances and reminiscences of the harmonies and tensions among the various modes of philosophical inquiry within the field. The co-chairs and co-respondents, both of whom have also made significant contribution to philosophy of communication in the discipline were asked to facilitate the panelists and audience through a discussion celebrating our past(s) and looking ahead into our futures.

The submission was accepted as one of the programmed Centennial Panels. From this point, we collaborated with the two co-chairs for the panel, Deborah Eicher-Catt and Pat Arneson, to develop questions that would open and guide panel discussion. The questions, as they were provided to the panels, included the following:

Topic 1: Relationships Between Philosophy, Rhetoric, Forms of Human Communication

1a. Philosophical Inquiry About Human Communication Existed Long Before "Philosophy of Communication" Became a Specialized Area of Research. What Do You See As the Origins of "Philosophy of Communication"?

1b. How Has This Area of Investigation Changed over Time (Past 100 Years)?

Topic 2: Philosophy of Communication As an Area of Inquiry

2a. Which Pasts – in the Form of Landmark Events or Individuals Thinkers – Influence Our Understanding of Communication As the Lived, Immediate Presence?

2b. What Do You Recognize to Be Significant "Turning Points" in Our Development As a Field of Study That Dramatically Shifted Our Philosophizing?

Topic 3: Deepening Our Contribution to Human Communication

3a. How Does Philosophy of Communication Shape the Identity of Communication Research As a Field?

3b. What Do You See As Key Thinkers, Research Areas, or Communication Topics That Have Been Neglected or Ignored to the Detriment of Our Current Theorizing?

Topic 4: Considerations for Future Inquiry

4a. How Does Contemporary Life Reveal a Need for Philosophy of Communication?

4b. What Do You See As Important Future Areas of Philosophical Inquiry About Human Communication? What Avenues of Current Research Do You See As Particularly Beneficial for Philosophy of Communication?

The remaining part of this essay includes four sections devoted to each panel participant's response to the above questions.

Communication and Philosophy at the Crossroads

Calvin O. Schrag

Topic 1: Relationships Between Philosophy, Rhetoric, Forms of Human Communication

1a. Philosophical inquiry about human communication existed long before "philosophy of communication" became a specialized area of research. What do you see as the origins of "philosophy of communication"?

Philosophical inquiry about communication did indeed exist long before "philosophy of communication" became a specialized discipline. It existed in the market place of ancient Athens where Socrates made a public nuisance of himself by bombarding the citizens of Athens with questions about living the good life. In the course of his conversations, he presented his interlocutors with the well-known existential imperative "Know thyself," with its corollary "the unexamined life is not worth living." Philosophical inquiry as a form of communication played a pivotal role in the philosophy of Plato, the student of Socrates. Indeed, given his choice of the dialogical format for articulating his philosophical ideas, it would need to be said that philosophical inquiry for Plato was not so much ABOUT communication, but rather that philosophical inquiry IS communicative discourse. Philosophical inquiry as it relates to communication can be found in Aristotle's *Rhetoric*—and especially in his concept of "political-deliberative rhetoric"—which augers toward a consideration of what is good for the polis. And if Heidegger's assessment of Aristotle's *Rhetoric* as providing the first systematic hermeneutic of everyday being with one another has any credibility, then surely inquiry about communication in philosophy was alive and well in Aristotle's philosophy. In the wake of the contributions of the likes of Socrates, Plato, and Aristotle, the framers of the medieval trivium picked up the importance of the role of communication in philosophical discourse in their tripartite format of logic, grammar, and rhetoric. Numerous other historical illustrations of the entwinement of philosophy and communication could be cited. So this part of the question can be dealt with quite straightforwardly.

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The second part of the question, dealing with the origins of the specific discipline of "philosophy of communication," is more difficult to address. There are different possible perspectives to take in addressing this matter. Speaking from the side of philosophy, I would suggest—and this is simplified to the extreme—that the origins are to be found in the portrait of the map of modern philosophy with its *foundationalist methodological preoccupations.* We speak of this as the "epistemological turn" in the history of philosophy, of which Descartes is usually cited as the principal representative. What transpired in this epistemological turn was that logic and epistemology were accorded primacy for the laying out of the first criteriological principles on which all veridical knowledge claims rest. Criteria for genuine knowledge need to be laid out in advance. After this is achieved, we can then apply philosophical principles and norms to different areas of disciplined inquiry. For example, we can then chart specific investigations in the so-called "subdisciplines" of "philosophy of science," "philosophy of religion," "philosophy of language," "philosophy of morals," "philosophy of art," "philosophy of literature," etc. So why not also "philosophy of communication"? Although the specific discipline of communication arrived on the scene somewhat later, it eventually found its place alongside the growing subdisciplines in philosophical inquiry.

Now, the persisting bugbear! Might there not be a problematic feature in this portrait of the origins of philosophy of communication as a special discipline? The underlying, and clearly questionable, presupposition is that philosophy provides the unimpeachable foundations for knowledge claims across the various fields of human inquiry and endeavoring (what I refer to in one of my writings as "the Greyhound Bus Syndrome of Philosophy"—leave the thinking to us!). It was as though one could somehow "apply" quite specific philosophical methods and truth claims across the disciplines. This of course has much to do with the Age of Enlightenment mindset with its accentuated theory/ practice dichotomy. Philosophy is to provide the theoretical foundations for any practical applications. Herein, I suggest, resides the endemic problem of all "philosophy of . . ." subdisciplines.

So this now becomes our challenge. How do we articulate what it is that we do in our "philosophy of communication" talk as "a specialized area of research"? How is the entwinement of the issues in our discourse to be expressed without gravitating back into the sterile and wooden theory-versus-practice bifurcation? Might the substitution of an "and" for an "of" be helpful, or the use of a slash, or some other kind of syntactic connector, all towards emphasizing an *envelopment* of the contributions of philosophy and communication—and might it not be that in investigating this envelopment, we find *not* that communication is something that one addresses after one has explored the terrain of the principles of first philosophy, but rather that communication itself is somehow veritably constitutive of philosophical discourse? In this connection, experimenting with a notion of *postdisciplinarity* might be of some help, opening vistas across sedimentary disciplinary borders.

1b: How has philosophy of communication changed over the past 100 years?

I suspect that there are multiple agents of change at work, but it may well be that the principal change has to do with the advent of technology and its ushering in of

the so-called "information age," making possible an ever increasing rapidity of sending bits of information through cyberspace—which has both its positive and negative effects. Information retrieval may well be a helpful instrument in sending data far and wide, but it can lead to a distressing conceptual confusion when it becomes synonymous with "distance learning." Information retrieval is not the same as achievement of insight; data storage and its transmittal are not to be equated with learning. Creative learning is always an embodied event achieved with the other—the bespeaking of face and gesturing of the body in contextualized exchange with the other. Information retrieval may well function as a tool in this process, but it can never take its place.

Topic 2: Philosophy of Communication As an Area of Inquiry

2a. Which pasts—in the form of landmark events or individual thinkers—influence our understanding of communication as the lived, immediate presence?

In response to this question, I would list three landmark events with their associated individual thinkers: (1) the rise of structuralist linguistics, the origins of which need to be ascribed to Ferdinand de Saussure; (2) the landmark event of logical empiricism (positivism), including the names of Rudolph Carnap, Moritz Schlick, A.J. Ayer, and others; and (3) transcendental logic, which of course goes back to Kant but was given a phenomenological twist in the early writings of Edmund Husserl, and especially in his two-volume *Logical Investigations*.

Structuralism produced the discipline of the science of linguistics with its benchmark of the signifier/signified distinction in which the play of *parole* and *langue* are operative. Although de Saussure did not suppress the role of *parole*, the event of speaking in the communication of everyday affairs, he did bracket its importance as a lived, immediate presence so as to focus his attention on the structure of *langue* as a system of syntax with its elemental units of lexemes, morphemes, and phonemes. Thus, the semantic became subordinated to the syntactical, gravitating to a linguistic formalism in which semantics as the carrier of meaning, enabled by saying something to someone else about something loses its relevance to lived experience. Communication in the life world of everyday discourse and action requires a semantic move to the sentential level and ultimately to the display of narratives in the lives of the vulgar well as of the learned. The negative effect of this alleged structuralist foundationalism in its dealing with the "human sciences" by the likes of Levi-Straus, Althussar, Barthes, and the early Foucault, quickly became apparent—they lost the concretely existing, speaking human subject.

Now the situation with regard to the landmark development in logical empiricism had similar consequences. The use of language had relevance only in "communicating" abstracted truths of formalized logic and empirical science. Statements like "A square is an equilateral rectangle" and "sugar is soluble" are meaningful statements because they meet the criteria of analytical-apriori and synthetic-posterior verification. Statements within the fields of ethics, aesthetics, and religion, for example, fail the test

and hence are considered to be cognitively meaningless. Not much room is left for communicating truths about concretely lived human existence.

The third landmark, the transcendental phenomenology of the early Husserl, did not address the issues of language and communication directly. However, Husserl's distinction between indication and expression (*Anzeigen* and *Ausdruck*) in his *Logical Investigations* did set the stage for a kind of linguistic turn, but his main purpose was to do battle with the British utilitarians, specifically John Stuart Mill, who sought to reduce logic to psychology. Now Husserl did extend the scope of phenomenology to include matters of perception, imagination, and judgment, but even these were guided by the investigations in another early work, *Philosophy as a Rigorous Science*. It is only in his last and posthumously published work, *The Crisis of the European Sciences*, that we are we notified that philosophy as a rigorous science has become a dream that is now "dreamed out," as Husserl stages what he called his "return to the lifeworld."

2b. What do you recognize to be significant "turning points" in our development as a field of study that dramatically shifted our philosophizing?

This second question of Topic 2 can be addressed as a follow up of the first question, framed as the "turning points" in the "landmark events" of the recent pasts. The turning point in the history of structuralism was the internal critique that followed from it, resulting in a deconstruction of its principal tenets, most aggressively in Derrida's grammatological dismantling of the signifier/signified foundation of structuralist linguistics and a shift to the textuality of our writing and speaking. Meaning in our written and spoken discourse is inescapably contextualized. Context rather than elemental syntactical units governs our speaking and thinking.

Now it could also be said t hat the deconstructive turning point counters the reductionism of logical empiricism. There are no hard and foundationalist facts, somehow bereft of interpretation, that can carry the day on matters of meaning and reference. In our communicating we can never achieve a foundationalist epistemological certainty. We are destined to cope with uncertainty—an undecidability of meaning and an indeterminacy of reference. Another turning point in the attack on logical empiricism can be found in the philosophy of William James, with its doctrine of "radical empiricism," in which the enjoyment of "pure facts" by the positivists is shattered by what James calls "world facts" that are open to the perception, imagination, reminiscences, emotions, and aesthetic responses of an embodied experiencer.

The turning point in the landmark development of transcendental phenomenology, as we have already indicated, was in part occasioned by the author of transcendental phenomenology himself, when he made his move away from the lure of philosophy as a rigorous science to a description of the language and action in play within a concrete lifeworld. However, the most decisive turning point in this landmark was the development of existential and hermeneutical phenomenology by Heidegger and Merleau-Ponty, Gadamer and Ricoeur, and it is in the thought of these thinkers the turning point very much turns on bringing communication to the forefront in philosophical reflection.

Topic 3: Deepening Our Contributions to Human Communication

3a. How does philosophy of communication shape the identity of communication research as a field?

It provides resources for broadening and enriching the meaning of "research as a field." Research becomes more than the assemblage of data (serialization of events, statistical projections, etc.), and in doing so it enriches the meaning of field as a wider interpretive context. It contextualizes the data by placing it into a wider narrative—and gives especial attention to shifting historical paradigms (as Thomas Kuhn does in his book on scientific revolutions). The background issue has to do with the late 19th- and early 20th-century disputations on the role of facts and interpretations in the natural and human sciences. Nietzsche may have overstated matters somewhat when he said that there are no facts—only interpretations; but he did succeed in bringing the issue to the forefront. Wilhelm Dilthey, however, may also have overstated the case when he wrote his oft-quoted one liner: "Man we understand; nature we explain." Although clearly enough there are differences between the more qualitative features in the field of the human sciences and the more quantitative features in the field of the natural sciences, but there may indeed be understanding and explanation going on in both the investigations of human existence and those undertaken in the researches within the sciences of nature.

We indeed are of the mind that there are, and what overlaps the two is an operative hermeneutic of frames of interpretation—which Ricoeur has articulated in his marvelous metaphor of "the hermeneutical arc." Interpretation is at work in both the human and the natural sciences, albeit in differing postures. The lesson to be learned from this is that the identity of communication as a field requires attentiveness to the play of interpretation when it defines the specific markers that comp rise its field of investigative research.

3b. What do you see as key thinkers, research areas, or communication topics that have been neglected or ignored to the detriment of our current theorizing?

Key thinkers and their works would include the following:

(1) Martin Heiddegger, *Being and Time*
(2) Hans-Georg Gadamer, *Truth and Method*
(3) Maurice Merleau-Ponty, *Phenomenology of Perception*
(4) Thomas Kuhn, *Scientific Revolutions*
(5) Paul Ricoeur, *The Conflict of Interpretations*
(6) Richard Rorty, *Philosophy and the Mirror of Nature.*

Key communication topics would include the following:

(1) the theory versus practice issue
(2) the fact/value dichotomy
(3) the function of metaphor in human communication
(4) the politics of communication

(5) the constitution of communication as a "discipline"
(6) postdisciplinarity in future communicative discourse.

Topic 4: Considerations for Future Inquiry

4a. How does contemporary life reveal a need for philosophy of communication?

Contemporary life reveals a need for philosophy of communication in several different regions of human concerns: (1) Communication within the local space of the neighborhood. Given the increasing multicultual diversity in the modern day neighborhoods—different spoken languages, different professions, different forms of labor, different standards of living—experimentation with new forms of everyday conversations are needed. (2) Communication on the professional level, such as the existing corporate and academic worlds, with their increasing hyper-specialized vocabularies, which puts stresses and strains on productive communication with one another. This is quite evident in a distressing feature of the contemporary academy where often conversations across the disciplines break down because of idiosyncratic usages of specialized terminology but also within the disciplines themselves —when, for example, specialists in the field of symbolic logic and specialists in aesthetical theory find no common conversational ground. (3) It is especially in the political world that communication is prone to break down. And here the principal problem may be what Gadamer has identified as the fault of misunderstanding residing not in the impropriety of speaking but rather in the inability to listen. Political discourse tends to congeal into dogmatic political stances, assumed to be unassailable, obviating any need to listen to opposing points of view. Genuine communication always requires a touch of humility coupled with a drive for understanding amid difference.

4b. What do you see as important future areas of philosophical inquiry about human communication?

The most critical area in which philosophy of communication can make a future contribution is in the field of international relations. The challenges here are overwhelming—but they need to be addressed. The inability of nation states to communicate on matters of international diplomacy can only lead to an ever-increasing existential threat for the entire planet. As long as we have the nation-state model for world politics, as Einstein predicted some years ago, we will live under the threat of certain nation states developing increasing armaments of world destruction. The option is that of increasing the capabilities of the war machine (which seem to be virtually unlimited) or putting to use the gift of language and communication which is ours to use in the framing of a workable world diplomacy. This may indeed call for a critical revision, or indeed abandonment, of the nation-state ideology itself—which has been with us since the Treaty of Westphalia—and move in the direction of a *post-national* constellation for world affairs. World diplomacy is rooted in the persuasive power of communication. This I submit is the most important feature of communication for the future of our planet.

The Creative Praxis of Philosophy of Communication

Ronald C. Arnett

Topic 1: Relationships Between Philosophy, Rhetoric, Forms of Human Communication

1a. Philosophical Inquiry About Human Communication Existed Long Before "Philosophy of Communication" Became a Specialized Area of Research. What Do You See As the Origins of "Philosophy of Communication"?

My response is situated within my knowledge of the West. It seems that the point of origin, at least an arguable point of origin, was with the Sophists. What the Sophists brought to the table of conversation was the recognition of bias. As they moved from one city-state or polis to another, they recognized differences in human engagement. Communication presupposes difference, particularly as we attempt to ascertain new information, insights, and knowledge. When Hans-Georg Gadamer was asked what generates insight and knowledge, his response was bias and prejudice. At the heart of philosophy of communication are the discovery, the explication, and, at times, the unmasking of bias and prejudice—that is what propels insights, understanding, and knowledge. From my philosophical perspective, modernity called into question the importance of philosophy of communication as it relied on processes and procedures rather than the explication of human bias between and among persons. For me, in terms of my work, philosophy of communication is the explication of human stories situated within distinct and unique perceptual commitments. Philosophy of communication reminds us about what matters in our conversation with one another, and, simultaneously, assumes that what matters to me may not matter to another. Indeed, the Sophists were correct in this.

1b. How Has This Area of Investigation Changed over Time (Past 100 Years)?

The primary shift in philosophy of communication from the Sophists to today is that the arguments of the Sophists about bias are now dominant presuppositions in the study of philosophical material. Continental philosophy and postmodern scholarship has provided a reminder of the situated nature of who we are. There is no one philosophy of communication. There are, however, multiple philosophies of communication as people seek to articulate what matters.

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Topic 2: Philosophy of Communication As an Area of Inquiry

2a. Which Pasts—in the Form of Landmark Events or Individual Thinkers—Influence Our Understanding of Communication As the Lived, Immediate Presence?

The central metaphor in this question is presence. The most thorough description of the emergence of presence in communication was penned by Martin Buber in his piece titled *The Dialogic Principle.* One can also understand this question with the notion of experience and how signs speak within experience, and the work of Charles Sanders Peirce is another major marker. Further, the insights of Edmund Husserl and the presence of the thing itself, and the then existential responses to his phenomenological work through Martin Heidegger, Hans-Georg Gadamer, Michel Foucault, and others, to name but a few, are also of note. Presence is tied to the notion of experience and to the recognition of something that shapes and informs us outside the internal realms of the speakers. Philosophically, presence has often been explicated by the notion of the third. The argument centers seldom on the notion of the third but rather where the presence of the third originates.

The starkest disagreement on the notion of presence is registered between Martin Buber and Emmanuel Levinas, with Levinas rejecting the entire construct of the I-Thou, unwilling to assume that communicative presence resides in a special location. Levinas counters with the phrase, "beyond dialogue." The presence resides beyond the dialogue, in the needs of the neighbor and those not seated at the table of conversation. One could study this question for a lifetime, ending up with a final conclusion: communicative presence is not a point of agreement, but a point of contention, and where we see it spark shapes our perceptual engagement with the human condition. In the words of multiple people who study Jewish philosophy, *where one attends or discovers holy sparks, illumination begins.*

2b. What Do You Recognize to Be Significant "Turning Points" in Our Development As a Field of Study That Dramatically Shifted Our Philosophizing?

The question has a significant personal dimension to it. My study with Algis Mickunas, who at that time was the President of the Husserl Circle, introduced me to phenomenology and to existential phenomenology. The key metaphor that he emphasized was that of understanding—that the task of phenomenology was not to tell, but to understand. This simple but elegant metaphor opens up the field of communication with one basic presupposition—what must we understand before we speak? Philosophy of communication is the communicative background that must be understood before we engage discourse with others. Additionally, that background is in the midst of the conversation and in reflective engagement afterwards. The person who put this orientation in words is Calvin Schrag. Schrag points to a philosophy of communicative engagement propelled by the prepositions of by, about, and for. He then, in this communicative praxis model that he so thoughtfully explicates, *results* in a rhetorical turn. Eventually we take that background, and it propels our discourse in a rhetorical turn.

The study of philosophy of communication is the preparatory material for the rhetorical turn. The material that is transformed during rhetorical engagement, and the

material that shifted and altered in a reflective encounter, long after the discourse of a particular other is concluded in temporal terms. Philosophy of communication is the signification dwelling that makes a rhetorical turn possible.

Topic 3: Deepening Our Contribution to Human Communication

3a. How Does Philosophy of Communication Shape the Identity of Communication Research As a Field?

As my previous answer indicated, I cannot separate philosophy of communication from rhetoric. I was convinced by Calvin Schrag's insightful analysis. Signification requires a dwelling. In scholarly terms, that home is philosophy of communication. It is the gathering place of meaning. Such an orientation assumes that philosophy of communication must take into account not only information, but human sentiment about that information. The interplay of what matters with what we know constitutes philosophy of communication, and if something matters, it can propel relationships, careers, and participation in the public domain.

The interplay of human communication, for me, is taking what matters to another. Sorting out the specific place of philosophy of communication within human communication is not my task. Such is the reason I tend to use the term "field," not "discipline." If we are a discipline, such a sorting must be accounted for—as a field, there are parts of what we call communication that are neighbors. There are different neighborhoods. Sometimes they communicate, and sometimes they do not, but together they generate communities. At our best, we are a field of ideas that generates a community of thought. That is good enough for me. Philosophy of communication is the dwelling place of signification, and relationships and the public domain are the places we walk to take what matters into the human task of engagement with another.

3b. What Do You See As Key Thinkers, Research Areas, or Communication Topics That Have Been Neglected or Ignored to the Detriment of Our Current Theorizing?

I am not sure that I could propose areas that have been necessarily neglected, but I can articulate why I think some particular Catholic philosophers are attractive to the work that I do such as Charles Taylor, the author of *Sources of the Self, Secular Age, The Ethics of Authenticity,* and *Modern Social Imaginaries*, a number of wonderful works, and of course Alasdair MacIntyre in his works *After Virtue, Short History of Ethics*, and *Three Rival Versions of Moral Enquiry*. In each case, they tell about philosophy emerging (in my language and terms) as a practical response to a given historical moment. Philosophy, and in this case philosophy of communication, does not emerge out of a vacuum but out of real lives, real issues, and real people trying to address questions in a given historical time frame.

My interest in history is broadened by my interest in what Gadamer refers to as historicity. Historicity suggests that given questions frame the identity of a given historical moment or context. Studying history for its own sake has, for me, limited value and utility. Studying history, however, as a philosopher of communication, enables me

to see connections between and among different eras and epochs in terms of historicity —that is, similar questions are being answered by people whose lives are separated, at times, by centuries. Currently, I am working on a project for the Scottish Enlightenment—the entire piece is a philosophy of communication treatise on ethics and local soil in which I articulate how a given history matters. I am not sure I would say there is a lot that is neglected. Others, I am sure, will have thoughtful responses. But I am impressed by those doing history tied to philosophy. It opens up communicative implications that are, in my judgment, profound.

Topic 4: Considerations for Future Inquiry

4a. How Does Contemporary Life Reveal a Need for Philosophy of Communication?

If we think we live in an era in which the correct answers have been discerned and our task is one of implementation and followership alone, then the study of philosophy of communication should not beckon us. Of course, I view this historical moment as confused, problematic, and, at times, bleak, on the edge of an abyss. Therefore, the study of philosophy of communication that examines the biases, assumptions, and frameworks of signification that matter is an absolute necessity.

One of my favorite insights from Richard Bernstein, who wrote *Beyond Objectivism and Relativism,* to name but one of his important works, is that we live in a curious time in which the philosophical and the practical have crisscrossed. I view philosophy of communication as a practical necessity for understanding and engaging the world before us, one that we have helped become confounded, confused, and perhaps corrupted.

4b. What Do You See As Important Future Areas of Philosophical Inquiry About Human Communication? What Avenues of Current Research Do You See As Particularly Beneficial for Philosophy of Communication?

If a graduate student came in and asked me that question, I think my answer would have three basic coordinates. The first would be to read a great deal, not only about philosophies but also about the people who generated them, the historical moments in which they were in, and the questions that their theories were trying to answer. The second would be to live, to enjoy your life with friends, with family, with all the different kinds of opportunities that are before us, to travel, and to learn about what we do not currently know at whatever age we are. And the third would be to find hobbies within the humanities that stir your soul, what my good colleague Annette Holba talks about as leisure. I like to think of leisure as a "doing" activity, with a musical instrument, whether that be your voice or, in my colleague's case, a violin. Philosophy of communication requires you to read, to live, and to embody the humanities.

By reading philosophy, history, and what has been engaged in a given moment, by living life with a passion and a commitment that does not allow you to forget how precious each day is, and by taking time to embody the humanities, we will find new directions and that will happen organically, as it should. Philosophy of communication

needs to be understood and engaged, and it cannot be falsely constructed; it is not another form of social construction. I think, at this moment, of a colleague by the name of Bernie Beranek who reminded me every day of the importance of reading. When he greeted me, he did not say "Hello"; his first question was, "What are you reading?" and then he talked about what he was engaging at that moment. I miss him; I miss his greeting. What have you read today? Living, the incredible joy of meeting each day, and caring for the people around us is not tangential but in my judgment central to philosophy of communication attentive to human meaning.

I remember being so fortunate to have mentors in my Ph.D. program who modeled such a conviction. I was fortunate enough to room for over 20 years at conferences at NCA with Paul Boase, and never once when I met him did I think that life was being undervalued. He reminded me of the importance of each day and the embodied humanities. I have alluded to the work of Annette Holba, but my colleague, Janie Harden Fritz, when she sings one can hear her soul vibrate in the engagement of life. Aristotle, perhaps, was right. We need standard bearers to remind us about the importance of reading, living, and embodying the humanities. There are many others such as Algis Mickunas, Ray Wagner, and Isaac Catt that point to a philosophy of communication that does not shy away from signification and meaning but instead seeks to find the revelatory within ideas and life itself. We have imposed enough upon the earth; it is better, perhaps more prudent, in this historical moment for us to listen and wait because the answers come as we read, we live, and we do the humanities rather than just talk about them, or, most vilely, attempt to possess them. Thank you.

The Apparent Ease of Communication: A Few Reflections on the Philosophy of Communication

Ramsey Eric Ramsey

Topic 1: Relationships Between Philosophy, Rhetoric, and Forms of Human Communication

1a. Philosophical inquiry about human communication existed long before "philosophy of communication" became a specialized area of research. What do you see as the origins of "philosophy of communication"?

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Once we have something called the philosophy of communication gathered around institutions and practices of teaching and research (not to mention a division in a national association), we are then able to return to the tradition to find what now cannot help but be seen as precursors, allies, and inspirations, ones we could not have known in advance would have led to all of this, and to our being involved in these practices and associations. This allows the tradition to remain rich for us as a heritage, and ever thoughtful and endless returns to it remain, I think, essential to telling our story and understanding who we are.

The origin will remain to be determined, and it will remain a circumscribed yet malleable beginning always, one from which theory will emerge and alter any precise and definitive origin one may wish were there. We ought to have gratitude for the fact this question will not admit to being settled. In this way, we are allowed to find the not-yet said in what has already been said but which keeps speaking if we but know how to listen and converse with it. Here I have found Gianni Vattimo—a great left-wing student of Gadamer—helps my understanding of why we would look to see what the tradition has still to hand down to us and inform the on-going talk of our origins: "the classics, the things that have held out, weren't perhaps necessarily classics right from the outset, things destined to hold out, but the fact that they did become classics involves me, what I am is largely the fruit of their endurance." Consequently, we are able to find in what has endured ideas and concepts anticipating and enriching what we think central to sophisticated philosophies of communication and what they might offer contemporary thinking. Moreover, philosophical hermeneutics teach us how we converse with these texts and make, as we say, the most of them.

1b. How has this area of investigation changed over time (past 100 years)?

I am most taken by how well those engaging in the philosophy of communication have sought thinking wherever we find it helpful to do so, as I have noted above. Anyone who works with words, who thinks about how language discloses what matters belongs justly to our list of conversation partners. From literary theory, for instance, I find my colleague Richard Dienst's *The Bonds of Debt* and *Still Life in Real Time* important contemporary books in the philosophy of communication, even if it does not (nor ever likely would) occur to him to call them such. Thus, we might say we need to think the phenomenon with anyone who is helpful to us at least as much as focusing narrowly on those in the discipline to find how to be relevant to the present state of thinking communication philosophically.

Topic 2: Philosophy of Communication As an Area of Inquiry

2a. Which pasts—in the form of landmark events or individuals thinkers—influence our understanding of communication as the lived, immediate presence?

2b. What do you recognize to be significant "turning points" in our development as a field of study that dramatically shifted our philosophizing?

Obvious yet worth noting, of course, foremost here is the coming to North America of Continental philosophy by way of phenomenology (my former student Jessica Sturgess is working on a wonderful article-length telling of this important story). The

ability to think philosophically outside the tradition of Anglo-analytic philosophy is, for me, what has allowed us to have philosophy of communication in and with the shape it has today. Prudent to mention also here works such as Dewey's *The Public and Its Problems* and Cornell West's *The American Evasion of Philosophy* which shows us a heritage of what will come to be seen as being continental-like in the North American traditions before analytic philosophy's takeover of the study of philosophy in the North American academy.

From this Continental way of thinking we have learned, I still believe, even if it is so difficult to think this way without falling back into bad habits, the idea that communication is not a thing, not an entity, not something human beings do in any simple sense of that word; rather it is first and foremost–or even deeper than that–what allows any human doing to be done at all because it is our way of being. This alone remains enough of a call for the importance of safeguarding the types of study we all undertake in our teaching and research for the overall heath of any study of communication and its consequences (and this belief of mine anticipates, no doubt, my response concerning question three below).

Before human beings are able to communicate in the everyday sense and being able to get better at doing this through practice and guidance, there is a communication they cannot help but be. This is where I believe the landmark insight resides: communication is a way of human being's ability to be at all. It is not something we might do only when we decided to say something or remain quiet. From the start and always communication is what being human is. Although so much follows from this and communication scholars study it all, it remains the case it all follows from this. This same philosophical tradition also makes us think carefully what we might mean when we say "human" in the phrase human communication. I would say we learn the human is essential yet not dominate, essential but not master, essential without being reducible to an isolated and naive subjectivism.

This way of thinking has a number of names we might cite here and a number of classic books (sometimes more famous than studied). From my own teaching I list here five sets of philosophers whose various works make up the majority of the required reading lists in my seminars (in both undergraduate and masters-level classes) others will, of course, have their own, but these do no little work in my experience: (1) Plato, Aristotle, Greek tragedies; (2) Descartes, Spinoza, Vico; (3) Hume, Kant, Hegel (Schiller); (4) Marx, Nietzsche, Freud; (5) Husserl, Heidegger, Derrida. Current philosophers of communication, as I said, will list others (and I, of course, teach books by others than these) yet the point is also this: to do philosophy of communication one also has first to be able to do philosophy (Henry Johnstone made this point a number of times years ago, as did and does still Calvin Schrag).

I think we know something of the health of the philosophy of communication as a rich area of study by way of being able to associate the work of each of these philosophers listed above with the names of past and contemporary thinkers who identify with the study of communication. To take but one from among the many possible powerful examples: we read better and learn more from Brinakle Chang's *Deconstructing Communication* if we have in fact studied Derrida, who we in turn understand

better if we have read and engaged Husserl and Heidegger, who we understand better . . . one sees how this goes.

Topic 3: Deepening Our Contribution to Human Communication

3a. How does philosophy of communication shape the identity of communication research as a field?

3b. What do you see as key thinkers, research areas, or communication topics that have been neglected or ignored to the detriment of our current theorizing?

Whether our work does in fact influence others not identified with philosophy of communication, I am not certain, yet it ought to be able to produce theory that can be taken to so-called real-world situations and produce insightful understandings of social life. There are many, Pat Arenson, Michael Hyde, and Amit Pinchevski, for example, who produce theory out of doing philosophy of communication and move in the same work to case studies allowing us to understand better. Furthermore, we ought to be able to also inform understanding in other disciplines (as a teacher I do this with undergraduate psychology majors) showing the centrality of communication to their intellectual concerns.

As to our neglects, I also believe philosophers of communication have the task of blurring the disciplinary boundaries and encouraging a postdisciplinary academy, even though I take seriously the defenses of the discipline made by some with whom I share this panel. There is so much work being done in radical ways by many scholars associated with communication studies, and their work needs to be not only welcomed but allowed real influence in those places where we are doing the work of the philosophy of communication (those on this panel, it will be noted well before I am able to do so, have a bit, shall we say, too much in common). Work has been done by feminists in philosophy of communication from which there is much more to learn this is true as well of the work of queer theory, and the wide ranging theory done by and about persons of color and in postcolonial studies. In addition, I would also say it seems to me a sophisticated understanding of psychoanalysis still has major contributions to make to our understanding of communication. I think those already doing this work would welcome philosophers of communication in conversations with them. In my own teaching and writing, the work of the contemporary psychoanalyst Adam Phillips is nearly indispensible.

Topic 4: Considerations for Future Inquiry

4a. How does contemporary life reveal a need for philosophy of communication?

4b. What do you see as important future areas of philosophical inquiry about human communication? What avenues of current research do you see as particularly beneficial for philosophy of communication?

As odd as it may sound, the ubiquity of communication and its endless successes from the salt and pepper being passed upon request at the dinner table to satellites hitting their marks, all because communicating among persons is working, is all the

more reason philosophers of communication need to be suspicious about communication, about the price we pay for everything working smoothly, ever suspicious about how easy it can often seem (the last pages of David J. Gunkel's *Thinking Otherwise* seem essential reading here). Because communication always seems to be working we need show how this working hides what does not work from an ethical standpoint, showing for whom it does not work, and saying as clearly as we are able who is paying dearly for the apparent ease of communication. The philosophy of communication participates in keeping open thinking about communication, as such thinking is always threatened by a reductionism that leads to misunderstandings, to say the very least.

Philosophy of Communicology: "Discourse Which Expresses Itself Is Communication"

Richard L. Lanigan

We are celebrating 100 years of the academic, professional, perhaps scholarly, study of speech communication in the U.S.A.[1] It is a disciplinary accomplishment, as Michel Foucault might say, that moves from the *eídos* Name (*Ónoma*) of "Public Speaking" to "Rhetoric" to "Speech" to "Speech Communication" to "Communication" to the present "Communicology".[2] My presentation today continues a eulogy of "PHILCOM History" I wrote a few years back for the Philosophy of Communication Division (#9) of the International Communication Association.[3] We are celebrating by philosophic reflection on those past 100 years with the present moment marked by the panel title: "Being (T)here". Although expressed in American English, the title has the flavor of a French aphorism turned Germanic in that it critically announces both a *problematic* (There) and *thematic* (Here) in the dialectic tradition of Hegel, yet also suggests the demarcation of analytic and synthetic judgment (Being) by which Kant separates reason (consciousness) and sensibility (experience). Of course, I am recounting the review by return (*renvoi* more appropriately in French) by Edmund Husserl to *metaphysics* after the epistemological *crisis of the European sciences* marking the collapse of Positivism. A hundred years later, the crisis problematic was repeated during 1967–1969 in Paris with the attack on statistical research by *La Commune Étudiante* under

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the political banner of *Selbstbestimmung* [self-determination: a critical self awareness of the political meaning of the "social science" research model].[4]

Thus, it is more than obvious that "Being (T)here" recalls the Heideggerian ontology of *Mitsein, Da-sein, und Dasein*[5], i.e., what Maurice Merleau-Ponty correctly translates into French as *être-au-monde* [being in and toward the world]. As Heidegger argues, "Ontological inquiry is indeed more primordial, as over against theoretical inquiry of the positive sciences." *"Only as phenomenology, is ontology possible."*[6] Indeed, we must note that in taking up the ontology of *Logos,* he argues (following Hegel and Kant) that the *Logos is Discourse* (*Rede*): an *ontological synthesis* that is *speaking* [*Sprechens*], i.e., *être-au-monde.*[7] "Discourse which expresses itself is communication".[8]

This Germanic problematic of the ontology of *speaking* (Rhetoric)[9] is essentially negative, what Bourdieu calls the "academic logocentrism, whose limit is set by the verbal fetishism of Heideggerian philosophy".[10] While I agree with Bourdieu's critique, I want to advance the *positive* counterpart (Tropic Discourse; New Rhetoric) in the *facticity turn* that was introduced by the *French reading of Husserl*[11] that paralleled, but was distinct from, Martin Heidegger's Germanic reading, undertaken by, among others, Maurice Merleau-Ponty, Michel Foucault, and Pierre Bourdieu.[12] Recall that Merleau-Ponty was the first French scholar to do research at the Husserl Archive at *Université de Louvain* in March 1939. Thus, the turn to *embodied consciousness* (facticity) in the *human sciences* represents a turn away from the "essences" (facticity) grounding Husserl's transcendental phenomenology. Ironically, Husserl was was the source of the *facticity turn* inasmuch as his *Paris Lectures* were heard by a young student from the *École normale supérieure* (ENS). It is 1929, Merleau-Ponty's last year at the ENS, when he goes to a public lecture by Edmund Husserl entitled "Introduction to Transcendental Phenomenology". Given in German on 23 and 25 February, the four hours of lecture are in honor of Husserl's recognition by the *Académie Française* for his contribution to philosophy. The formal and extended text is published that same year as *The Cartesian Meditations.*[13]

Considered Husserl's mature thought, the Paris lectures assert both an (1) *existential* and (2) *semiotic* proposition that grounds the *human science facticity* to be found in the thematic future work of Merleau-Ponty. Husserl says: (1) "Everyone of us who has been guided back, through phenomenological reduction, to *his* absolute ego discovered himself, with apodeictic certainty, as an *actual existent*".[14] (2) "The essential characteristic of the ego is persistently to form *systems of intentionality,* as well as to possess *systems already formed,* whose *indices* are the objects which the ego means, thinks, values, handles, imagines, or could possibly imagine, and so forth".[15] (3) "In this manner, transcendental *subjectivity is expanded to become intersubjectivity,* to become an intersubjective transcendental *community,* which in turn, is the transcendental ground for the intersubjective being of all ideal objectivities".[16]

The three phenomenological thematics are taken up in semiotic terms when Merleau-Ponty begins to study Saussure's descriptions of the expression and perception of discourse about 1940. And, we must importantly note that Merleau-Ponty was succeeded at ENS by Georges Gusdorf who was the first in Paris to lecture on the *philosophy communication.* These famous lectures were the basis of his 1953

book entitled simply *Speaking* [*La Parole*].[17] His phenomenological classification of communicology as *langage, langue, discours, and parole,* became the foundational classification of *tropic logic* (rhetoric) still in use in philosophy and the human sciences.[18] This dominant *facticity of discourse* model is a given understanding among French intellectuals. The understanding derives from the Greek epistemology that grounds the French understanding of *Tropic Discourse.*[19] Also in the context of facticity, Gusdorf was famous for his field trips to asylums to expose students to the *abnormal discourse* of mental patients (i.e., phenomenological free variation). Among his more famous ENS students are Louis Althusser, Pierre Bourdieu, and Michel Foucault (who graduates from ENS in 1946 having had Merleau-Ponty's examination preparatory course).

Returning to my opening comment, I mentioned the progression of German thinking by way of noting that in 1977 (29 May to 4 June) the *First World Congress on Communication Science* took place in Berlin, Germany. The subtitle of this congress was the "27th Annual Conference of the International Communication Association". It was in fact the first "outside the U.S.A." meeting of ICA. At that congress, I proposed and led an Action Causes on the Philosophy of Communication. Some 30 international scholars attended. I should note that at this time my friend and colleague Roland Posner was establishing the Research Center for Semiotics in the Linguistics Institute at the Technical University of Berlin. The Action Caucus later became an Interest Group that mutated into *Division 9: Philosophy of Communication* at the 1985 meeting of the ICA. In 2005, a 20-year retrospective of the PHILCOM Division was held, and I presented a paper that chartered the philosophic currents in the conference program papers over those years. I offered this abstract of the article:

> The systems of thought operating in the Philosophy of Communication Division of the International Communication Association are explicated. Kant's philosophy of logic is used to define the analytic/synthetic distinction as the metaphysical foundation of Modernity. The methodological ground of Postmodernity is a critique of positivism using Kant's logic and C. S. Peirce's semiotic phenomenology of Abduction, Deduction, Induction, and Adduction. The analysis deals with the philosophical ground for the Human Science of Communicology.[20]

The primary references to Kant's philosophy are his *Logic*, *Critique of Pure Reason*, and *Critique of Judgment.* My technical analysis of these issue in relation to *rhetoric* is forthcoming.[21]

In 2013, ICA Division 9 changed its name to "Philosophy, Theory, Critique" to accord with its last 10 year focus on the crypto-marxist analysis of media studies, now to be featured a new journal entitled: *Sound.* The title appears to be a reference to the historical origins of film history in which "sound" was successfully merged onto film as a recording medium, thus the capitalist motion picture industry initiated by the brothers Auguste and Louis Lumière in Lyon, France became available for *linguistic* political critique. In short, the "future" crypto-marxist problematic of capitalism regresses to the "past"as the the 19th century neo-marxism of yesteryear in the semantic Name mutation *of* Philosophy, *to* Theory, *by* Critique—a *logocentric entropy*

predicted by Husserl as the crisis of human science! Please recall that Kant's program is the critique of theory to ground philosophy!

Meanwhile, the NCA has appropriately (as human science) become the academic home for the study of the philosophy of communicology, having emerged as the Philosophy of Communication Division from the Semiotics Interest Group. While Semiotics is virtually synonymous with "communication" everywhere in the world except the U.S.A., it is nonetheless at the intellectual center of the American contribution to the philosophy of communication. This strange historiography is wonderfully explicated by Isaac Catt and Deborah Eicher-Catt in their longitudinal account of the non-influence of semiotics on research published by SCA/NCA.[22]

Remembering the hermeneutic constraint of the last 100 years in America, what are the *conceptual origins* of the Philosophy of Communication in the U.S.A.? My short historical answer is the *Yale School of Communicology*.[23] This is to say, the conjunction of Philosophy (in the persons of Wilbur Marshall Urban and Ernst Cassirer, their student Hubert Griggs Alexander) and Linguistics (in the persons of Edward Sapir and his student Benjamin Lee Whorf) all at Yale University. Alexander and Whorf were doctoral classmates in the seminars of their professors; later, I was a student of Hubert Alexander and a colleague of his son, Thomas, a professor philosophy at Southern Illinois University.

As the first American introduction of Edmund Husserl's phenomenology, Urban publishes his *Language and Reality: The Philosophy of Language and the Principles of Symbolism* in 1939.[24] He says, "The essence of language is the representation, *Darstellung*, of one element of experience through another—the *bi-polar relation* between the sign or symbol and the thing signified or symbolized, and the consciousness of that *relation*".[25] His footnote reads: "The two most important influences in the development of this speech-notion are said to be F. de Saussure, *Cours de linguistique génerale*, ed. Ch. Bally (1916, 1922), and E. Husserl, *Logische Untersuchungen*, second edition, 1913."

While Urban had read Karl Bühler's *Die Krise der Psychologie* (1927), he was unaware that Bühler had completed his *Sprachtheorie, die Darstellungfunction der Sprache* (1934).[26] The same correction of Saussure and Husserl in the context of Communication was undertaken almost simultaneously in Philosophy by Urban and in Linguistics by Karl Bühler; both relied heavily on Cassirer's phenomenology of communication and culture.[27] The conjunction of Urban and Bühler finds its synthetic expression in Alexander's *The Language and Logic of Philosophy* and other works.[28] This book also expresses a synthesis of the forgotten conversation on qualitative and quantitative methodology wherein the apposition of *phenomenology* and *semiotics* took place among Adolph Löwe, Alfred Schütz, Harold D. Lasswell, and Charles W. Morris. The conversation continued at the Macy Foundation conferences (1950s) in which the Claude Shannon and Warren Weaver (Skinner behaviorist) view of "machine information" was devastatingly corrected by the "human cybernetics" theory of communication of Norbert Weiner, Gregory Bateson, and Margaret Mead.[29]

Although there is barely any influence of Semiotics on the NCA in general, it would be a mistake for the future not to recognize that the Philosophy of Communication in the last 100 years in America is almost a direct response to the semiotic influence of Charles S. Peirce whose adoption of Husserl's phenomenology has now become the method of *Semiotic Phenomenology,* which I have labeled *Communicology*.[30] It was Peirce who adopted the *Trivium* of medieval philosophy to create his divisions of Semiotics: *Speculative Grammar, Exact Logic, and Speculative Rhetoric.* At present and contrary to Charles Morris' intent,[31], these categories are corrupted and made theoretically incoherent by modern behavioral linguistics as: Syntactics, Semantics, and Pragmatics; the NCA equivalents are: Conversational Analysis, Message Analysis, and Rhetorical Analysis, this last itself now corrupted largely as Media Analysis. All this to say historically, Peircian semiotics in America was already accomplishing the corrections to Saussure and Husserl that were to come years later from Urban and Bühler, then Schütz and Morris, and finally, Weiner, Bateson, and Mead.

Why Semiotics and Cybernetics did not have a more powerful contemporary influence on American *Philosophy* is a parallel historical case to why Semiotics and Cybernetics ("social systems theory") did not have a disciplinary influence on American *Communication*. In both cases, the shift from issues of *Metaphysics* (Theory Construction) to those of *Epistemology* (Methodology; reductive in the case of informatics and statistics) resulted in a grand illusion promoted by the *mechanization of measurement* (engineering technology) during the last 100 years. It is classic case of the *fallacy of the tool*, i.e., *actuality* is defined by the tool (*reality* idea) used to perceive it. In short, "object experiment" replaces *subject experience* and "instrument" (apparatus) replaces *reason* (logic) such that Epistemology invents its own Metaphysics (Merleau-Ponty calls this the "psychologist's fallacy").[32] This is precisely what Foucault means when he explains "the forgetfulness of rationality" where rationality is the *epistēmē* created by taxonomies of epistemology, especially where those taxonomies are made algebraic with arithmetic referents (numbers for things). This is to say in the Human Sciences, the false contest between quantitative and qualitative methods (an epistemology of *probability*) replaced the more difficult challenge of mathematics versus logics (a metaphysics of *possibility;* Husserl's theme) where *reasonableness* (*eulogos*) is prior to *rationality* (*logos*). This *angst* story is just our own version of the crisis lived through in the last 100 years by Husserl, Bühler, and Weiner.

With the insights of Peirce and Mead (about Kant and Hegel), together with those of Merleau-Ponty and Foucault (about discourse and embodied medium),[33] we have rediscovered the metaphysics of reasonableness in Culture (Cassirer, Jakobson), rather than in the rationality of Nature.[34] Metaphysics as the *medium* of *embodied human existence* (not Nature's *things*) is reconstituted as the *ontological ground of reasonableness* (ethics, community) prior to the invention of rationality (expediency, self-interest) by Epistemology. As Roland Barthes argues, the Signifier (Rhetoric) is *not* the Signified (Ideology). This is the core concept of the *New Rhetoric* and its methodology of *Tropic Discourse.*[35]

What does this all mean for NCA? It means that the disciplinary identity grounded in *the study of messages* (the construction and analysis of a physical *signal channel*) is paradoxical at best, semantically pointless at worst. Analytic epistemology is the very condition of *unlimited semiosis*, i.e., the infinite regress of *Information Theory*. Rather, we must understand the metaphysical advice from Heidegger: "*Only as phenomenology, is ontology possible*". The place to begin is the ground of human communication and culture, i.e., the conscious *medium of comportment:* the logic of synthesis found in discourse, i.e., *Communication Theory*. Following Roman Jakobson's communicology of *distinctive features* (what we *do not* say [paradigmatic] as *context* (study of *encode choices*) for what we *do* say [syntagmatic]) and *redundancy features* (what we do say [synchronic] as context (study of *decode choices*) for what we do not say [diachronic]), Merleau-Ponty summarizes the *logic of synthesis*, i.e., *Communicology Theory:* "Sensibility, regulation, transformation: these words designate a lived experience". "The enumeration of possible combinations [information theory] does nothing to help us understand the very act by which language takes on a meaning [communication theory]".[36] This definition is a good summary of what Weiner, Bateson, and Mead mean by *Cybernetics,* best renamed as *Communicology Theory*.

By way of summary (Table 1), I am suggesting in the Kantian tradition that the Philosophy of Communication specifies that the *Code of Discourse* is synthetic (Grammar), that the *Meaning of Discourse* is synthetic (Logic), and that the *Medium of Discourse* is synthetic (Rhetoric). Using Peircian *normative logics* dating back to the medieval *trivium,* we abandon the epistemological *Taxonomy of Language* known as Information Theory. Instead, we acknowledge: (1) the metaphysical *Hierarchy of Discourse* respectively entailing *Langage, Langue, Discurs,* and *Parole* (ontological embodiment: *être-au-monde*) known as Communication Theory, and (2) the epistemological S*ynthesis of Codes* as human communication in Communicology Theory (Discourse Communicology: *sensibility, regulation, transformation*)[37].

Remembering again the hermeneutic constraint of the last 100 years in America, what are the *institutional program origins* of the Philosophy of Communication? The short answer here is to simply note the thousands of research publications (including several hundreds of Ph.D. dissertations) produced by more than 50 years of faculty and graduate student collaboration that took place in the the United States of America among (1) *Southern Illinois University* (Departments of English, Foreign Languages & Literatures, Philosophy [including the Dewey Center, and, the Library of Living Philosophy], and Speech Communication), (2) *Purdue University* (Departments of Communication and Philosophy), and (3) *Duquesne University* (Departments of Communication & Rhetorical Studies, Psychology, and Philosophy [including the Simon Silverman Phenomenology Center]). What about the future? Well, the collaboration continues from here,[38] as the Discipline of Communicology (tagged by the term *Communicology* in current encyclopedias) begins to spread globally with the dialogue and research collaboration stimulated by the *International Communicology Institute*,[39] the international emergence of Departments of Communicology at the universities, and, last, the global development of scholarly societies devoted to focused research on the Philosophy of Communication (PHILCOM).

Table 1 Semiotic Phenomenology of Communicology

PHILOSOPHY OF COMMUNICOLOGY		
Linguistic Synthesis Hierarchy: *Langage* → *Langue* → *Discours* → *Parole*		
GRAMMAR *Code of Discourse* Eidetic-Empirical Synthesis	**LOGIC** *Meaning of Discourse* Self - Other Synthesis	**RHETORIC** *Medium of Discourse* Embodiment Synthesis
Induction* *Charles S. Peirce Definitions	**Deduction***	**Abduction*** (particular; *a posteriori;* Token > Tone) **Adduction*** (universal; *a priori;* Type > Token)
Case + Result = Rule CODE CONSTITUTION, NOT Message Construction	Rule + Case = Result CODE SYNTHESIS, NOT Message Analysis	Rule + Result = Case CODE MEDIUMN (Embodiment), NOT Message Channel
	Methodology Descriptor Terms	
Husserl: Horizon Heidegger: Mitsein Merleau-Ponty: Description Foucault: Archaeology Peirce: Object	Husserl: Field Heidegger: Da-Sein Merleau-Ponty: Reduction Foucault: Genealogy Peirce: Ground	Husser : Core / Focus Heidegger: Dasein Merleau-Ponty: Interpretation Foucault: Critical Methodology Peirce: lnterpretant
	Discourse Descriptor Terms	
Husserl: *Noema* Heidegger: Discourse *[Rede]* Merleau-Ponty: Language/ Discourse *[Langage > Discours]* Foucault: Utterance *[Énonciation]* Peirce: Speculative Grammar	Husserl: *Noesis* Heidegger: Social Discourse *[Gerede]* Merleau-Ponty: Speech Spoken *[Langue > Parole Parlée]* Foucault: Uttered Knowledge *[Énonciation; Connaissance]* Peirce: Exact Logic	Husserl: Transcendental Ego Heidegger: Communication *[Kommunikation]* Merleau-Ponty: Speech Speaking *[Parole > Parole Parlante]* Foucault: Expressing Understanding *[Énoncé; Savoir]* Peirce: Speculative Rhetoric
Information Theory Merleau-Ponty: ***Sensibility*** *Either* Signifier *Or* Signified *Digital Logic*	Communication Theory Merleau-Ponty: ***Regulation*** *Both* Signifier *And* Signified *Analogue Logic*	Communicology Theory Merleau-Ponty: ***Transformation*** *IF (both* Sr *and* Sd), *THEN (either* Sr *or* Sd) *Binary Analogue Logic*

Notes

[1] National Communication Association (U.S.A.), Centennial Celebration Series Panel: "*Being (T)here*", Philosophy of Communication Division, Chicago, Illinois , 21 November 2014.

[2] For an explication of terminology used, see: "Greek Voices of Discourse and Epistemology Explicated in French Discourse (Handchart 1995/2015)", an online PDF: http://siu.academia.edu/RichardLLanigan

[3] Richard L. Lanigan, "Paradigm Shifts: Recalling the Early ICA and the Later PHILCOM", *The Review of Communication* 8 (2005): 377–82.

[4] Richard L. Lanigan, *Phenomenology of Communication: Merleau-Ponty's Thematics in Communicology and Semiology* (Pittsburgh, PA: Duquesne University Press, 1988), 76.

[5] Pascal David, "Heidegger's *Dasein*" in *Vocabulaire européen des philosophies: Dictionnaire des intraduisibles* (Paris: Éditions de Seuil/Dictionnaires Le Robert, 2004). Trans. Steven Rendal et al.; ed. Barbara Cassin, *Dictionary of Untranslatables: A Philosophical Lexicon* (Princeton, NJ: Princeton University Press), 198–200.

[6] Martin Heidegger, *Sein und Zeit,* 7th ed. (Tübingen: Neomarius Verlag, 1926). Trans. John Macquarrie and Edward Robinson, *Being and Time* (New York: Harper & Row, Publishers, 1962), 31, 60.

[7] Ibid., 55–56.

[8] Ibid., 211; Dermot Moran, *Introduction to Phenomenology* (New York: Routledge; Taylor & Francis Group, 2000), 229.

[9] Heidegger, ibid., 178.

[10] Pierre Bourdieu, *Ce que parler veut dire* (Paris: Libraire Arthème Fayard, 1977–1984). Trans. Gino Raymond and Matthew Adamson, *Language and Symbolic Power* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1991); *L'Ontologie politique de Martin Heidegger* (Paris: Éditions de Minuit, 1988). Trans. Peter Collier, *The Political Ontology of Martin Heidegger* (Stanford, CA: Stanford University Press, 1991).

[11] Edmund Husserl, *Logische Untersuchungen,* 2nd ed. (Halle: M. Niemeyer, 1910–1913). Trans. J. N. Findlay, *Logical Investigations,* 2 vols. (London, U.K.: Routledge & Kegan Paul; New York: Humanities Press, 1970).

[12] Richard L. Lanigan, "Convergence Constitutes the Horizon of Divergence: In Dialogue with Calvin O. Schrag", *Russian Journal of Communication* 7, no. 1 (2015): 94–101; Samuel IJsseling, *Rhetoric and Philosophy in Conflict: An Historical Survey* (Boston: Martinus Nijhoff, 1976).

[13] Edmund Husserl, *The Paris Lectures,* trans. Peter Kostenbaum (The Hague: Martinus Nijhoff, 1967); *Cartesian Meditations: An Introduction to Phenomenology,* trans. Dorion Cairns (The Hague: Martinus Nijhoff, 1969).

[14] *Paris Lectures:* 27; my emphasis.

[15] *Paris Lectures:* 25.

[16] *Paris Lectures: 35.*

[17] *La Parole* (Paris: Presses Universitaires de France, 1953). Trans. Paul T. Brockelman. *Speaking [La Parole]* (Evanston, IL: Northwestern University Press, 1965).

[18] Maurice Merleau-Ponty, Maurice (1995). *La Nature: Notes, cours du Collège de France* (Paris: Éditions de Seuil, 1995). Trans, Robert Vallier, "The Notions of Information and Communication" in *Nature: Course Notes from the Collège de France* (Evanston, IL: Northwestern University Press, 2003): 158–66.

[19] Heidegger, *Being and Time,* on Greek metaphysics: 203–6; on communication: 203–6; on early Greek *logos,* see Heidegger, *Early Greek Thinking.* Trans. David Farrell Krell and Frank A. Capuzzi (New York: Harper & Row).

[20] See note 2 above.

[21] Richard L. Lanigan, "Immanuel Kant (1724—1804)", *International Encyclopedia of Communication Theory and Philosophy,* ed. Klaus B. Jensen (Hoboken, NJ: Wiley-Blackwell, 2016).

[22] "Semiotics in Mainstream American Communication Studies: A Review of Principal U.S.A Journals in the Context of Communicology", *The Review of Communication* 12, no. 3 (July 2012): 176–200.

[23] Richard L. Lanigan, "Defining the Human Sciences," *Schutzian Research—A Yearbook of Lifeworldly Phenomenology and Qualitative Social Science* 3 (2011): 9–11; "Husserl's Phenomenology in America (U.S.A.): The Human Science Legacy of Wilbur Marshall Urban and the Yale School of Communicology": 203–17.

[24] Urban (1939); New York: Books for Libraries Press; Arno Books, reprint ed.1971.

[25] New York: Books of Libraries Press; Arno Books, reprint ed. 1971: 66, 66n.

[26] Karl Bühler, *Sprachtheorie: Die Darstellungsfunktion der Sprache* (Jena/Stuttgart: Gustav Fischer Verlag, 1934, 2nd ed. 1982). Trans. Donald Fraser Goodwin, *Theory of Language: The Representational Function of Language,* Foundations of Semiotics: Vol. 25 (Amsterdam: John Benjamins Publishing Co., 1990); "The Axiomatization of the Language Sciences" in Robert E. Innis, *Karl Bühler: Semiotic Foundations of Language Theory* (New York: Plenum Press, 1982). Note (translation error) that *Dastellungfunction* is "presentation" (not "representation") and contrasts with *Ausdruckfunction* that is "expression".

[27] Ernst Cassirer, *The Philosophy of Symbolic Forms:* Vol. 1: *Language,* Vol. 2: *Mythical Thought;* Vol. 3: *Phenomenology of Knowledge;* Vol. 4: *The Metaphysics of Symbolic Forms,* trans. R. Manheim (New Haven, CT: Yale University Press, 1957, 1995). Original works published 1923, 1925, 1929. Richard L. Lanigan, "Ernst Cassirer's Communicology and Culturology: The Theory and Method of Semiotic Phenomenology" (in press).

[28] Hubert G. Alexander, *The Language and Logic of Philosophy* (Lanham, NY: University Press of America, 1967, 1972, 1988); *Meaning in Language,* College Speech Series (Glenview, IL: Scott, Foresman, and Co., 1969); "Communication, Technology, and Culture", *The Philosophy Forum* (Special Issue: *Communication*) 7, nos. 1–4 (September 1968): 1–40.

[29] For a language account, see Richard L. Lanigan, "Information Theories" in Paul Cobley and Peter Schulz (eds.), *Theories and Models of Communication, Vol. 1,* Handbooks of Communication Science, 22 vols., 2012–2019 (Berlin: De Gruyter Mouton, 2013): 58–83; online PDF: http://siu.academia.edu/RichardLLanigan. For a mathematical account, see William Ross Ashby, *An Introduction to Cybernetics* (New York: John Wiley & Sons, Inc., 1956), 179.

[30] Richard L. Lanigan, *Speaking and Semiology: Maurice Merleau-Ponty's Phenomenological Theory of Existential Communication,* Approaches to Semiotics, Vol. 22 (Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter, 1972, 2nd ed. 1991); *Semiotic Phenomenology of Rhetoric: Eidetic Practice in Henry Grattan's Discourse on Tolerance* (Washington, DC: Center for Advanced Research in Phenomenology and University Press of America, 1984); *The Human Science of Communicology: A Phenomenology of Discourse in Foucault and Merleau-Ponty* (Pittsburgh, PA: Duquesne University Press, 1992).

[31] Morris says: "For in a wide sense of 'phenomenological' a behavioral semiotic is phenomenological since it includes a description of observer; and a narrower use of the term (the description by an individual of his own sign-process) is covered by our admission of self observation, an admission which is compatible with either a behavioral or a mentalistic

psychology, and so does not decide between them". Charles Morris, *Writings on the General Theory of Signs* (The Hague: Mouton, 1971),105.

[32] A readable account of information theory (Shannon, Weaver) versus communication theory (Weiner, Bateson, Mead) is Gregory Bateson and Margaret Mead, "For God's Sake Margaret", *The CoEvolution Quarterly* (Summer 1976): 32–44; see especially the diagram on p. 37. A more current source is Ronald R. Kline, *The Cybernetics Moment: Or Why We Call Our Age the Information Age* (Baltimore, MD: Johns Hopkins University Press), 229–31.

[33] Lawrence D. Kritzman, *The Columbia History of Twentieth-Century Thought* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2006), 526, 622.

[34] Maurice Merleau-Ponty, *La Nature: Notes, cours du Collège de France* (Paris: Éditions de Seuil, 1995). Trans, Robert Vallier, "The Notions of Information and Communication" in *Nature: Course Notes from the Collège de France* (Evanston, IL: Northwestern University Press , 2003),158–66.

[35] Roland Barthes, "Éléments de sémiologie", *Communications* 4 (1964): 91–135, trans. Annette Lavers and Colin Smith, *Elements of Semiology* (New York: Hill and Wang; Farrar, Straus and Giroux, 1967); "L'Ancienne rhétorique. Aide-mémoire", *Communications* 16 (1970): 172–229, trans. Richard Howard, "The Old Rhetoric: an aide-mémoire" in *The Semiotic Challenge.* (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1994): 11–93; Elmar Holenstein, *Roman Jakobson, ou sur le structuralisme phénoménologique* (Paris: Editions Seghers, 1974), trans. Catherine Schelbert and Tarcisius Schelbert, *Roman Jakobson's Approach to Language: Phenomenological Structuralism* [from German Habilitationschrift, Zurich 1974] (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1976); Group Mu, *Rhétorique générale* (Paris: Libraire Larousse, 1970), trans. P. B. Burrell and E. M. Slotkin, *A General Rhetoric* (Baltimore, MD: The Johns Hopkins University Press, 1981); Haden White, *Tropics of Discourse: Essays in Cultural Criticism* (Baltimore, MD: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1978); Anthony Wilden, *System and Structure: Essays in Communication and Exchange,* 2nd. ed. (London, U.K.: Tavistock Publications, 1972, 1980); Wilden, *The Rules Are No Game: The Strategy of Communication* (New York: Routledge and Kegan Paul, 1987).

[36] See note 32: 162–63; my inserts.

[37] See note 32.

[38] My most recent publications are: Richard L. Lanigan, "Human Embodiment: An Eidetic and Empirical Communicology of Phantom Limb", *Metodo: International Studies in Phenomenology and Philosophy* [Paris] 3, no. 1 (2015): 257–87; "Semiotic Confusion in the Phenomenology of Perception: West Meets East, One Actuality Becomes Two Realities", *Chinese Semiotic Studies* 11, no. 2 (2015): 227–62; "Semiotic Paradigms of Self and Person: The Perspectives Model of Communicology as the Logic Foundation of Human Science", *Language and Semiotic Studies* [China] 1, no. 1 (Spring 2015): 106–29; "Netizen Communicology: *China Daily* and the Internet Construction of Group Culture", *Semiotica* (2015) online publication; print pending for Issue 207 (2016): 1–40. Forthcoming articles include: (1) "Immanuel Kant (1724–1804)", (2) "Alfred Schütz (1899–1959)", (3) "Charles Sanders Peirce (1839–1914)", (4) "Jean Jacques Maurice Merleau-Ponty (1908–1961), *International Encyclopedia of Communication Theory and Philosophy,* ed. Klaus B. Jensen (Hoboken, NJ: Wiley-Blackwell, 2015 in press); (1) "Humanistic Communication Theory", (2) "Structuralism" in *The SAGE Encyclopedia of Theory: Humanistic and Scientific Perspectives,* ed. James Mattingly (Beverly Hills, CA: Sage Reference) (in press).

[39] Historical and descriptive information online: http://communicology.org